

AA-06

# Supplier Portal Specification

Twenty-six screens for product companies: catalog, shipments, returns, payouts

30 August 2026 · Rev 1.0 — baseline

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SCREENS

**26**

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PERMISSIONS

**17**

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ROLES PER ORG

**4**

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STEP-UP GATED

**2**

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PARTNER ENDPOINTS

**34**

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MINIMUM VIEWPORT

**360 px**

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This document specifies the product-company self-serve portal at seller.atavishaala.in: all 26 screens, the 4 roles inside a supplier organisation, and the exact boundary of what a tenant may see and do. The reader it is written for is FE-2, who builds it, and the reviewer of those pull requests. The reader it is written about is someone else entirely: an employee of another company, untrained, working a warehouse shift, possibly on a phone. It assumes AA-00 section 0.2 for why this is a separate portal, AA-02 sections 2.4 and 2.5 for how tenant scope is made unforgeable, AA-03 for the shipment split underneath every fulfilment screen, AA-04 section 4.4 for the endpoint behind every action, AA-05 for the admin side of moderation and return arbitration, AA-08 for permissions and PII, and AA-11 for the week each screen lands in.

## 6.1 WHAT THE SUPPLIER PORTAL IS FOR

Four jobs, one number they are all judged against, and three things this is deliberately not

A product company signs up to sell fertiliser, seed or equipment through the Atavishaala app. From that moment it has exactly four jobs, and this portal exists to let an employee of that company do those four jobs without ever ringing our office. List stock accurately. Accept and pack shipments on time. Handle what comes back. Get paid the right amount. Everything else on the screen is either in service of one of those four or it is decoration we have not deleted yet.

The design premise is narrower than the feature list suggests. The single number that decides whether this portal succeeded is the supplier on-time dispatch rate: the share of shipments made ready for collection before the ready-by time the supplier itself committed to. P5-BE1-02 materialises that number nightly as a rolling 30-day figure per organisation and shows the same value on AD-21 in the admin portal and on the supplier dashboard, so there is no version of it the supplier can argue with. Every screen in section 6.4 is answerable to it. If a screen does not help a warehouse clerk get a box to the gate sooner, or help an owner see why yesterday it was late, it needs a different justification.

That premise is also the reason the portal is not built around the catalog. Cataloging is the work of the first week of a supplier relationship; dispatch is the work of every day after. The navigation therefore opens on shipments, not products, and the dashboard tile order in P4-FE2-03 puts shipments to accept and ready-by breaches ahead of low stock and moderation.

| THE JOB                 | WHAT DOING IT WELL LOOKS LIKE                                                                                             | SCREENS        | WHAT GOES WRONG WITHOUT IT                                                                         |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| List stock accurately   | Live SKUs whose price and stock match the shelf, with compliance licences attached where the category demands one.        | SP-10 to SP-16 | Oversell, then a cancellation. The customer blames the platform, not the supplier.                 |
| Accept and pack on time | Every shipment acknowledged with an honest ready_by, packed against a ticked pick list, and at the gate before that time. | SP-04 to SP-09 | The promise on the customer order slips and the fleet offer broadcast starts late.                 |
| Handle what comes back  | Returns and RTO received within a day of arrival, condition recorded, evidence attached when the supplier disagrees.      | SP-17, SP-18   | Refunds stall behind an unreceived box and the customer waits on a supplier we cannot see into.    |
| Get paid correctly      | Every payout traced back to the shipments that composed it, at the commission that was actually applied at the time.      | SP-19 to SP-22 | Weekly reconciliation calls to finance, which is exactly the cost this portal was built to remove. |

## What this portal is not

Suppliers arrive with expectations formed by marketplaces that are ten years older than us, so it is worth writing down what we refused and why. Each refusal below costs us a conversation during onboarding and saves us a class of defect we cannot afford in a ten-week build.

| IT IS NOT                  | WHAT A SUPPLIER EXPECTS                                                                         | WHY WE REFUSED IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A storefront               | A branded shop page, banners, a promotions engine, a follower count.                            | Demand is ours to generate and ours to answer for. A per-supplier storefront makes the app a directory of shops rather than a catalog of products, and it would put merchandising decisions in the hands of a tenant we cannot review at that speed. Rejected outright, not deferred. |
| A chat tool                | A message thread with our staff, and eventually with the customer.                              | An in-portal inbox is a support product: unread counts, routing, SLAs, an audit trail, and someone watching it during business hours. We have none of that. Disputes go to the support line or to email, which is honest about the fact that a human answers them. See section 6.11.  |
| A window onto other people | Competitor prices, category demand, who else sells this SKU, the customer they are packing for. | Another supplier catalog is commercially valuable and not ours to give away. A customer identity is not ours either. Both are enforced structurally rather than by policy, which is what section 6.9 is about.                                                                        |

**THE READER THIS PORTAL IS WRITTEN ABOUT**

FE-2 builds it, but the person using it is an employee of another company. They were not hired by us, they were not trained by us, and they will not read a release note. On the fulfilment path they are a warehouse clerk on a shift, standing up, on a mid-range Android phone, in a building with poor signal. On the finance path they are a bookkeeper on a desktop who will compare our number against a spreadsheet. Those two people share a login screen and nothing else, and the concessions each one forces are the subject of sections 6.6 and 6.10.

**6.2 TENANCY FROM THE USER SIDE OF THE GLASS**

What invariant I-03 looks like when it is a screen instead of a middleware

AA-02 sections 2.4 and 2.5 describe tenancy as a server concern: the claim, the guard, the repo wrapper. This section describes the same invariant as the supplier experiences it, because the interface consequences are not obvious from the middleware. The short version is that a supplier user never makes a choice about which organisation they are acting for, never sees an identifier for their own organisation in a URL, and cannot tell from any response whether another organisation exists.

There is no organisation selector anywhere in the navigation, and that is not a simplification we can later reverse. A selector implies a set to select from, and a `partner_users` row belongs to exactly one `partner_orgs` row. The claim is minted server-side from that column at login; the token carries it as `partner_org_id` and nothing in the client can influence it. The practical test FE-2 should apply during review is blunt: if a component takes an `org id` as a prop, it is wrong.

**I-03 TENANT SCOPE COMES FROM THE TOKEN**

`partner_org_id` and `fleet_org_id` are read from the verified token claim only. A request body or query string that carries either is rejected with 400 `SCOPE_IN_REQUEST`. Enforcement: ESLint rule `aa/no-tenant-in-input` plus a repo-layer `scoped()` wrapper that is the only permitted entry point in `partner` and `fleet` namespaces.

One apparent exception deserves naming because a reviewer will find it and ask. `POST /partner/auth/login` accepts an `org slug` in the body alongside the email and password. That slug is not tenant scope: it runs before there is a principal at all, and its only job is to disambiguate a credential, since `partner_users` is unique on (`partner_org_id`, `email_ci`) rather than on email alone. A person who genuinely works for two supplier organisations has two credentials and signs in twice. After the token exists, a body or query string carrying `partner_org_id` is refused with 400 `SCOPE_IN_REQUEST` before the handler runs, and the ESLint rule `aa/no-tenant-in-input` fails the build if a Zod schema under `/partner` even declares the field.

Two staff accounts in the same organisation therefore resolve identically through different tokens. There is no shared password, no per-organisation subdomain and no tenant path segment, so a URL a warehouse lead pastes into a colleague message opens the right shipment for that colleague and a 404 for anyone outside the organisation. That property is what makes the portal safe to use the way people actually use software: by sending each other links.

**Following a link to something that is not yours: 404, not 403**

A supplier will eventually put another organisation shipment id into the address bar, either by mistyping one digit or because someone forwarded a link. The answer is a plain 404 with the ordinary not-found screen. Not a 403, not a denied state, not a message saying this belongs to another organisation. The row is treated as though it does not exist, because from inside that tenant it does not.

This is a deliberate divergence from the admin portal. AA-05 section 5.10 specifies that a staff user lacking a permission gets an explicit 403 and a denied panel naming the permission they would need, because a staff user is an employee, the permission set is documented internally, and telling them the truth turns a support ticket into a self-service request to their manager. None of those conditions hold for a tenant. A supplier learning that shipment 41883 exists but is not theirs learns our sequence density, and by extension roughly how much volume every other supplier is doing. A 403 is a read primitive on data we refused to give them in section 6.9.

The mechanism is that the `scoped()` wrapper from P3-BE1-02 adds the `org` predicate to the `where` clause rather than checking it afterwards, so the query genuinely returns zero rows and the handler has no ability to distinguish the two cases. P9-BE1-02 asserts this in the security suite: cross-tenant access returns 404, never 403, so tenancy is not enumerable. Where an authorisation failure is genuinely about the user own organisation, a missing permission on their own row, the answer is still a 403, because that reveals nothing outside the

tenant.

| WHAT THE USER DID                                       | ADMIN PORTAL                  | THIS PORTAL                                        | REASONING                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Opened a resource belonging to another organisation     | 403 with the permission named | 404 not-found screen                               | A tenant must not learn that the row exists. Existence is commercial information.                                                                   |
| Opened a resource that was deleted or never existed     | 404                           | 404                                                | Identical response to the row above, by construction rather than by convention.                                                                     |
| Opened their own resource without the permission for it | 403 with the permission named | 403 with the action named, not the permission code | Nothing leaks outside the tenant, so we can be helpful. The copy names the action, since a supplier has no permission catalog to look a code up in. |
| Called a /admin or /fleet route with a partner token    | n/a                           | 401 ACTOR_MISMATCH                                 | Rejected by requireActor() immediately after JWT verification, before any handler or permission check. Invariant I-02.                              |

## 6.3 ROLES INSIDE A SUPPLIER ORGANISATION

4 fixed role codes, 17 permissions, and the 2 actions that re-prompt for TOTP

A supplier organisation has 4 role codes and cannot invent a fifth. The partner permission set is 17 entries, listed in full in AA-08, and each role is a fixed subset of it. There is no role editor screen in this portal and there is not one in the admin portal either; cut C-4 removed custom roles from the whole programme on the grounds that the named seats cover every job we can describe today. The cost of that cut lands here more than anywhere else: a supplier whose warehouse lead should be able to see payouts but not change the bank account has to choose between PARTNER\_OPS and PARTNER\_FINANCE, and will ask us for a fifth role. The answer during the pilot is to give that person two accounts or make them an owner, and to write the request into the post-pilot backlog.

| ROLE CODE       | PERMISSIONS                                                       | WHAT THE SEAT IS                                                   | WHO HOLDS IT IN PRACTICE                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PARTNER_OWNER   | All 17 partner permissions                                        | The signatory. Exactly one per org, transferable by admin.         | Always the first account, created by the admin invite in P3-BE1-03. Usually the proprietor, who will also do the finance work. |
| PARTNER_CATALOG | p.catalog.*, p.shipment.read                                      | Lists and prices products. No money, no users.                     | Often unfilled at pilot scale; the owner does the listing themselves for the first few weeks.                                  |
| PARTNER_OPS     | p.shipment.*, p.return.*, p.manifest.print, p.catalog.stock       | Warehouse seat. Accepts, packs, hands over, receives returns.      | The seat that actually matters daily. Expect two or three of these and expect them all to be on phones.                        |
| PARTNER_FINANCE | p.payout.read, p.invoice.download, p.bank.manage, p.shipment.read | Reconciles settlement. Cannot change the shelf or move a shipment. | Frequently an external accountant. Give them this and nothing else, never an owner seat.                                       |

Only p.user.manage can invite, which in the shipped role set means PARTNER\_OWNER alone; no other role carries it. POST /partner/users takes an email and a role code, sends a single-use invite valid for 72 hours through Brevo, and the recipient lands on SP-02 to set a password and optionally enrol TOTP. There is no self-registration: a partner\_users row can only come into existence from an invite issued by an existing owner, or from the original owner invite issued by admin staff when the organisation was created. POST /partner/users/:id/disable refuses to disable the last PARTNER\_OWNER, in the UI on SP-25 and again in the API, because an organisation with no owner has no one who can invite a replacement and would need a staff intervention to recover.

## The two step-up gated permissions

Of the 17 partner permissions, exactly 2 require a fresh second factor at the moment of use rather than merely a valid session: requireFreshFactor(300) re-prompts for a TOTP code if the last one was more than five minutes ago. Both are account-takeover targets rather than ordinary mistakes, which is the test we applied. Packing the wrong box is recoverable and gated by nothing. Redirecting the settlement account is the entire point of stealing a supplier password.

| PERMISSION    | ENDPOINTS BEHIND IT                                  | WHY IT IS GATED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| p.bank.manage | PUT /partner/bank                                    | This is the only action in the partner namespace that changes where money physically goes. A compromised session with no step-up would let an attacker point the next weekly run at their own account and wait. Two further brakes sit behind the gate: the account enters PENDING_VERIFICATION and payouts pause until a staff member verifies it, and the account number is rendered as last four only from the moment it is saved, so the input is write-only and the screen cannot be used to read back an existing account. |
| p.user.manage | POST /partner/users, POST /partner/users/:id/disable | Inviting a user is privilege creation. Without a gate, one stolen owner session becomes a durable second owner account that survives the password reset, and disabling the real owner locks the organisation out of its own portal. Gating the invite makes the escalation path cost a second factor rather than a page load.                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

TOTP enrolment is optional for a supplier user at sign-up, which creates a wrinkle worth stating: an owner who skipped enrolment on SP-02 cannot satisfy the step-up, so the first attempt to save a bank account or invite a colleague pushes them into enrolment before the action proceeds. That is the intended behaviour rather than an error state, and the copy on both screens says so before the button is pressed. It is also why POST /partner/auth/totp exists for users who hold a finance role even when they have not enrolled: the finance seat cannot be operated without it.

What a supplier cannot do to roles at all is change who the owner is. PARTNER\_OWNER is exactly one per organisation and transferring it is an admin action, because the owner is the signatory on the pilot agreement and the person our KYC record names. A supplier asking to move ownership is a support request handled on AD-22, not a screen in this portal.

## 6.4 THE 26 SCREENS

Every route in the supplier portal, its permission gate, and what it is for

This is the complete inventory. 26 routes, no others; a route that is not in this table does not exist and a pull request that adds one needs this document amended first. The PERMISSION GATE column is the permission the router requires to mount the route at all, which is not the same as the permission needed for every action inside it: SP-06 is gated on p.shipment.read but its accept button additionally needs p.shipment.accept, and a PARTNER\_FINANCE user therefore reaches the screen and finds the button absent rather than disabled. The endpoint behind each action is in AA-04 section 4.4; the week each screen lands in is in AA-11.

## Getting in and getting started (SP-01 to SP-03)

Three screens that exist once per user and once per organisation. SP-03 is the only screen in the portal that is modal in spirit: while the organisation is in DRAFT or KYC\_SUBMITTED, every other route redirects to it, because a supplier who lists a product before KYC clears creates a moderation queue item we cannot approve and an expectation we cannot meet. P2-FE2-01 states that acceptance plainly: a DRAFT org sees the checklist, not the dashboard, on every route.

| ID    | ROUTE          | SCREEN               | PERMISSION GATE | WHAT IT DOES                                                                     |
|-------|----------------|----------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SP-01 | /login         | Sign in              | public          | Email + password. Org resolved from the email domain or a slug field.            |
| SP-02 | /invite/:token | Accept invitation    | invite token    | Set password, accept terms, optional TOTP enrolment.                             |
| SP-03 | /onboarding    | Onboarding checklist | session         | Five steps: profile, KYC, bank, first product, terms. Blocks selling until done. |

## The fulfilment path (SP-04 to SP-09)

The six screens the portal is actually for, walked in order in section 6.6. SP-04 is the answer to "what do I do next" and every tile on it links to a pre-filtered list rather than showing a bare number. SP-09 is the only screen in the set designed phone-first rather than merely made to work on a phone, because it is used standing at a loading bay with a rider waiting.

| ID    | ROUTE                | SCREEN              | PERMISSION GATE  | WHAT IT DOES                                                                             |
|-------|----------------------|---------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SP-04 | /                    | Supplier dashboard  | p.shipment.read  | Seven tiles: shipments to accept, ready-by breaches, low stock, moderation, next payout. |
| SP-05 | /shipments           | Shipments to fulfil | p.shipment.read  | Default AWAITING_ACCEPTANCE. Accept-all bulk action with a ready-by picker.              |
| SP-06 | /shipments/:id       | Shipment detail     | p.shipment.read  | Item lines, weight, COD flag, drop locality and pincode only.                            |
| SP-07 | /shipments/:id/pack  | Pack and confirm    | p.shipment.pack  | Tick each line, declare shortfalls, then mark ready for pickup.                          |
| SP-08 | /shipments/:id/label | Label and pick list | p.manifest.print | A4 print view: shipment code barcode, lines, drop pincode.                               |
| SP-09 | /handover            | Gate handover       | p.shipment.pack  | Scan or type the shipment code as the rider collects. Mobile-first.                      |

## Catalog (SP-10 to SP-16)

Seven screens covering the listing lifecycle described in section 6.5. The structural point in this group is SP-12: a supplier looking at an approved product sees the live version and their pending draft revision side by side, because the most common support call on any marketplace is a supplier insisting they changed something that customers cannot see. SP-16 exists for the same reason and shows the reviewer note verbatim, not a summarised version of it.

| ID    | ROUTE              | SCREEN            | PERMISSION GATE | WHAT IT DOES                                                        |
|-------|--------------------|-------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SP-10 | /products          | My products       | p.catalog.read  | Moderation chip, live price, stock, 30-day units.                   |
| SP-11 | /products/new      | New product draft | p.catalog.draft | Wizard: category, attributes, variants, media, compliance licence.  |
| SP-12 | /products/:id      | Product detail    | p.catalog.read  | Live version and draft revision side by side.                       |
| SP-13 | /products/:id/edit | Edit draft        | p.catalog.draft | Editing an approved product forks a revision; live stays untouched. |
| SP-14 | /stock             | Stock manager     | p.catalog.stock | Editable grid with ETag conflict detection and a CSV paste box.     |
| SP-15 | /pricing           | Price requests    | p.catalog.price | Proposed prices with their moderation state and reviewer notes.     |
| SP-16 | /moderation        | Review history    | p.catalog.read  | Every decision, who reviewed it, and the verbatim reason.           |

## Returns (SP-17, SP-18)

Two screens, one of which is deliberately missing a control. SP-18 gives the supplier a condition selector and a dispute button with a 48-hour countdown, and no way to reject a return; section 6.7 explains why the decision stays with admin staff and what the supplier gets instead.

| ID    | ROUTE        | SCREEN          | PERMISSION GATE  | WHAT IT DOES                                                  |
|-------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| SP-17 | /returns     | Returns inbound | p.return.read    | Customer evidence photos, expected condition, receive action. |
| SP-18 | /returns/:id | Return detail   | p.return.receive | Condition selector, dispute button with a 48 h countdown.     |

## Money (SP-19 to SP-22)

Four read-only screens. There is no mutating action anywhere in this group and no endpoint behind it other than a GET, which is the shape section 6.8 argues for: a supplier reads their settlement and disputes it through a human, and the only write in the finance area of the portal is the bank account on SP-23. SP-22 ships as a CSV rather than the PDF its description promises, per cut C-3.

| ID    | ROUTE           | SCREEN              | PERMISSION GATE    | WHAT IT DOES                                                     |
|-------|-----------------|---------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SP-19 | /payouts        | Payouts             | p.payout.read      | Accrued, in-run, paid, withheld. Withheld lines show the reason. |
| SP-20 | /payouts/:runId | Run detail          | p.payout.read      | Line-by-line gross, commission, TDS, net; UTR last four.         |
| SP-21 | /ledger         | Ledger              | p.payout.read      | Append-only running balance. No edit affordance anywhere.        |
| SP-22 | /invoices       | Commission invoices | p.invoice.download | One self-billed PDF per released run.                            |

## Settings and the organisation (SP-23 to SP-26)

Four screens that a supplier touches during onboarding and then roughly twice a year. Both step-up gated permissions from section 6.3 live here, and both of the write-only masked inputs do too: bank account and GSTIN render as last four only from the moment they are saved and there is no reveal control, for a supplier looking at their own data, exactly as AA-08 requires.

| ID    | ROUTE             | SCREEN               | PERMISSION GATE | WHAT IT DOES                                                    |
|-------|-------------------|----------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| SP-23 | /settings/bank    | Bank account         | p.bank.manage   | Last four only after save. Changing it pauses payouts.          |
| SP-24 | /settings/kyc     | KYC documents        | p.kyc.submit    | Seven document slots with status chips and reviewer notes.      |
| SP-25 | /settings/users   | Team                 | p.user.manage   | Invite by email with a role code; cannot remove the last owner. |
| SP-26 | /settings/profile | Organisation profile | session         | Display name, support contact, warehouse pincode, cut-off time. |

## The order these are built in

FE-2 owns every screen above and also the whole fleet portal, which is why the build order matters more here than it does for the admin portal. The sequence below is AA-11 restated by screen group. Note that the money and returns tasks in AA-11 quote an older screen numbering for those two groups; the IDs in this document are the authoritative ones and AA-11 should be corrected to match.

| WEEK | TASK      | SCREENS        | WHAT HAS TO BE TRUE AT THE END OF IT                                                                                                                                                       |
|------|-----------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| W2   | P2-FE2-01 | SP-01 to SP-03 | A fresh invite token walks to a usable session in under two minutes, and a DRAFT organisation sees the checklist rather than the dashboard on every route.                                 |
| W3   | P3-FE2-01 | SP-10 to SP-13 | A supplier creates a compliant draft with three variants and four images and submits it; an approved product they then edit does not change what customers see until it is approved again. |
| W3   | P3-FE2-02 | SP-14 to SP-16 | Two browser tabs editing the same variant produce a visible conflict rather than a silent overwrite, and a 200-row CSV paste returns a per-row result list.                                |
| W3   | P3-FE2-03 | SP-23 to SP-26 | An owner invites a catalog seat and a finance seat with the right permissions; bank and GSTIN are masked after save with a write-only input.                                               |
| W4   | P4-FE2-01 | SP-05 to SP-07 | Six shipments accepted and one packed with a shortfall in under three minutes, and a code review confirming no customer contact field is fetched by these screens at all.                  |
| W4   | P4-FE2-02 | SP-08, SP-09   | Six labels print on six pages from one click with no clipped barcode, and the gate screen works one-handed at 360 px.                                                                      |
| W4   | P4-FE2-03 | SP-04          | A supplier can answer what to do next from the dashboard alone, and a suspended organisation sees the banner and cannot reach a mutating screen.                                           |
| W7   | P7-FE2-01 | SP-19 to SP-22 | A supplier can reconcile any payout back to the shipments that composed it, and a period statement totals to the paise against the ledger rows for that period.                            |
| W8   | P8-FE2-01 | SP-17, SP-18   | A supplier cannot see any control that would change a return state, and every scorecard number links to the rows that produced it.                                                         |
| W9   | P9-FE2-01 | all 26         | The axe and keyboard pass clears at the same bar as the admin portal, and every offline retry queue drains after a network drop.                                                           |

## 6.5 CATALOG AND MODERATION

The listing lifecycle, what a supplier may change without a human, and why stock is an adjustment

A product a supplier creates does not exist for customers until a member of our catalog team approves it. `products.moderation_status` defaults to DRAFT after migration M3, and the path is DRAFT to IN\_REVIEW on `POST /partner/products/:id/submit`, then APPROVE, REJECT or DELIST from the admin side on AD-18. The part that matters for the interface is what happens to an already-approved product when the supplier edits it: `PATCH /partner/products/:id` forks a new draft revision and leaves the live row untouched, so the customer-facing listing never enters an intermediate state and a half-finished edit cannot go out. Approving the revision replaces the live row in one transaction. SP-12 shows both versions side by side so the supplier can see which one customers are looking at.

Not every change deserves a human. The rule we settled on is that anything which alters what the customer was told about the product goes back through review, and anything which only alters availability does not. Stock is availability. Price is a claim, but a claim whose direction matters, so it is handled by policy inside the queue rather than by exemption from it.

| WHAT CHANGED                   | WHAT HAPPENS TO THE LIVE LISTING                            | RE-REVIEW                      | REASONING                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stock quantity                 | Applies to the live variant immediately.                    | No                             | A quantity is not an assertion about the product. Blocking it behind review would guarantee overselling, because the queue is measured in hours and a warehouse count changes in minutes.                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Price                          | A price request; the live price holds until it is resolved. | Always enters the queue        | A decrease, or an increase inside <code>PRICE_AUTO_DELTA_BPS</code> of the last approved price, is auto-approved by the moderation service without a human touching it. Anything larger waits for AD-18. The threshold is a config value this document proposes at 1000 bps and it is not yet in the AA-07 environment table; it needs adding there before W3 closes. |
| Title, description, attributes | Forks a draft revision. Live is untouched.                  | Yes                            | This is the text a customer decided on. It is also where a listing quietly becomes a different product, which is the failure mode moderation exists to catch.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Images and media               | Forks a draft revision.                                     | Yes                            | Media is the easiest place to smuggle in a competitor logo, a phone number or a price overlay. It is cheap to review and expensive to miss.                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Category                       | Forks a draft revision.                                     | Yes, and re-checks the licence | Category drives the required_licence enum from P5-BE1-01. A move into a pesticide category without a verified pesticide licence is refused with 400 <code>LICENCE_REQUIRED</code> naming the document type, not silently approved.                                                                                                                                    |
| Variant added or removed       | Forks a draft revision.                                     | Yes                            | A new variant is a new sellable thing with its own price and stock. Treating it as an edit rather than a creation was the shortcut we rejected.                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

### MODERATION IS A HUMAN QUEUE WITH A TARGET, NOT AN SLA

There is no rota, no overnight cover and no second reviewer. Two people on the catalog team work the AD-18 queue during business hours, and our internal target is one business day from submit to decision. The portal therefore shows a submitted-at timestamp and the current state, and it deliberately shows no countdown and no promised time, because a promise we cannot staff is worse than an honest absence of one. What the portal does guarantee is that a rejection carries the reviewer note verbatim on SP-12 and in the SP-16 history, so a supplier is never told no without being told why. If the pilot pushes the queue past a day, the answer is fewer suppliers or more reviewers, not a faster screen.

## Stock is an adjustment, not a field

The obvious design for SP-14 is an editable number per variant: the clerk types what is on the shelf and it saves. We refused that as the stored contract, because two concurrent absolute sets lose work silently. A clerk counts a bin and sets 40. A second clerk, on a page loaded before that count, books in a delivery of 12 and sets 52 from their stale view of 40. One of those two facts is now gone and nothing in the system knows it. The same pair of events expressed as adjustments composes correctly in either order: a COUNT to 40 and a RECEIPT of +12 land as two rows and the shelf figure is their sum. An append-only adjustment log also gives us something an absolute field cannot, which is a shrinkage history: at the end of a month you can say how much stock was lost to damage rather than only that the number is lower than it was.

What ships is a compromise, and it is worth naming precisely because a reviewer will otherwise think the endpoint contradicts this section. AA-04 section 4.4 records `PATCH /partner/variants/:id/stock` as an absolute

quantity with an ETag guard. SP-14 collects the new count together with a mandatory reason code and sends the absolute value with If-Match on the variant stock ETag; a stale ETag returns 409 with the current server value and asks the clerk to decide, which is the visible conflict P3-FE2-02 requires instead of a silent overwrite. On success the server writes the append-only adjustment row with the computed signed delta and the reason, so the durable record is the log even though the wire shape is a quantity. The residual cost is real: a legitimate concurrent receipt is rejected rather than merged, and the clerk retypes it. A delta wire shape would merge both, the admin side already works that way on AD-20, and flipping the partner endpoint to a signed delta before the contract freeze is the recommendation this section makes.

| REASON CODE    | DIRECTION | WHEN A CLERK PICKS IT                                                                  |
|----------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| COUNT          | either    | A physical recount. The only code that may set a figure unrelated to the previous one. |
| RECEIPT        | positive  | Goods booked in from the supplier own procurement.                                     |
| RETURN_RESTOCK | positive  | A return received as SELLABLE on SP-18 and put back on the shelf.                      |
| DAMAGE         | negative  | Broken in the warehouse. The commonest negative code and the one worth reporting on.   |
| EXPIRY         | negative  | Past shelf life. Relevant for seed and for a good part of the agri-input catalog.      |
| LOSS           | negative  | Unexplained shrinkage. Kept separate from DAMAGE so the two can be counted apart.      |
| CORRECTION     | either    | Fixing an adjustment entered wrongly. Never an edit of the earlier row.                |

The reason code set above is proposed by this document and needs to exist as an enum in migration M3 before SP-14 is built. The CSV paste box on the same screen takes the same shape: up to 200 rows in one request, each carrying a variant reference, a quantity and a reason, returning a per-row result list so a supplier can see which twelve of their two hundred lines failed and why, rather than a single unhelpful rejection.

## 6.6 THE FULFILMENT LOOP

The eight moves a warehouse clerk makes, the endpoint behind each, and the clock they run against

This is the sequence the portal is designed around. It is written as a walk rather than a screen list because the failure mode we are guarding against is a clerk who is unsure what the next action is and therefore does nothing. Every step has exactly one primary action on screen. AA-03 describes the shipment split that produces step one; the sixteen-state shipment FSM underneath every transition is in AA-03 as well, and assertTransition refuses anything not on that list regardless of what the client sends.

1. The shipment appears. splitOrder() groups the order lines by partner\_org\_id and creates one shipment per supplier, at payment capture for prepaid orders and at COD confirmation for cash. It arrives in AWAITING\_ACCEPTANCE and shows up on SP-05, whose default filter is exactly that state. GET /partner/shipments.
2. Accept it and commit to a time. The clerk picks a ready-by and accepts, either one shipment at a time or with the accept-all bulk action and a single ready-by picker. The endpoint validates ready\_by against the organisation cut-off time from SP-26 and refuses a time that would break the customer promise. Stock was already reserved at order placement, so accepting is a commitment of labour, not of inventory. POST /partner/shipments/:id/accept, ready\_by in the body.
3. Read the lines. Item, quantity, total weight, whether it is COD, the promised-by time, and the drop locality and pincode. Nothing else about the destination exists in this response. GET /partner/shipments/:id.
4. Start packing. This moves ACCEPTED to PACKING and is the state from which a shortfall may still be declared; after the next step it cannot. POST /partner/shipments/:id/pack.
5. Declare a shortfall if the shelf disagrees with the screen. Per item, with a reason. The endpoint reduces shipment\_items, releases the reserved stock and queues a partial refund of those units plus proportional shipping, so an honest shortfall costs the supplier a metric hit and nothing else. POST /partner/shipments/:id/short-ship.
6. Print the label and the pick list. One A4 page per shipment with a Code-128 barcode of the shipment code, the lines to pick and the drop pincode. Print styles hide the navigation and force a page break between shipments so six labels come out of one click. GET /partner/shipments/:id/label.
7. Mark it ready for pickup. This is the point of no return: it triggers the fleet offer broadcast, and a delivery company starts making commitments on the strength of it. Short-ship is closed from here. POST /partner/shipments/:id/ready.
8. Hand it to the rider against the shipment code. The rider arrives and asks for the shipment; the clerk opens SP-09 and types the code. The supplier-side confirmation is POST /partner/shipments/:id/handover; the rider side is POST /fleet/jobs/:id/pickup, which asserts the shipment is READY\_FOR\_PICKUP and moves it to HANDED\_OVER in the same transaction. Custody, and the metric, close here.

## The ready-by clock

ready\_by is a wall-clock time the supplier chooses at step two and stores on shipments.ready\_by. It is not a duration we impose, and that is the whole design: a supplier who commits to four hours and hits it scores better than one who commits to one hour and misses. What the endpoint enforces is only the outer bound, that the

chosen time still leaves the fleet enough room to meet the customer promise on the order.

The obligation ends at `READY_FOR_PICKUP`, not at handover. On-time means the transition into `READY_FOR_PICKUP` happened at or before `ready_by`. A rider who turns up ninety minutes late is a fleet problem and appears on the fleet metrics; charging it to the supplier would make their number unactionable and they would stop believing it, which is the fastest way to lose the only lever this portal has. Two cron watches the two halves of the clock: `stale-shipment-alert` hourly for anything in `AWAITING_ACCEPTANCE` beyond four business hours, and `sla-watch` every ten minutes for a `ready_by` breach.

| WHEN A BREACH HAPPENS        | WHAT FOLLOWS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| On the supplier dashboard    | The breaching shipment appears in the ready-by breaches tile on SP-04 within one poll interval, linked to the filtered list rather than shown as a bare count.                                                                                |
| On the rolling metric        | It counts against the 30-day on-time rate computed nightly by P5-BE1-02. The identical figure renders on AD-21 in the admin portal, so a conversation about performance starts from one number rather than two.                               |
| On the admin exception board | AD-07 has a dedicated <code>ready_by</code> breach lane, populated by the same query <code>sla-watch</code> runs. Ops sees the breach whether or not the supplier logs in.                                                                    |
| In the runbook               | RB-02: ops calls the supplier, and if no commitment can be obtained the shipment is cancelled and the customer refunded, with the on-time metric flagged. Cancellation releases the reserved stock through the inverse conditional statement. |

#### CUT C-5: THERE IS NO CAMERA SCAN AT THE GATE, ONLY TYPING

The rider mobile scan camera was cut for two dev-days. SP-09 therefore accepts a typed shipment code only, and so does the rider side. What that costs, honestly: entering a code by hand on a phone at a loading bay is roughly fifteen to twenty seconds against about two with a camera, and it introduces transcription errors that a scan does not. A wrong code returns `409 GATE_CODE_MISMATCH` and is rate limited to five attempts per job, which is the right protection against guessing and the wrong experience for a clerk with wet hands and a similar-looking pair of codes. The mitigations are cheap and we take all three: generate shipment codes from an alphabet with no 0, 0, 1, 1 or 5, render the input as large monospace with the expected length shown, and echo the matched shipment lines back before the confirm so a mismatch is caught by eye rather than by the error. At six shipments a morning across two pilot suppliers this is an irritation. At sixty it is not acceptable, and the camera comes back in Phase 2 before volume gets there.

## 6.7 RETURNS

Two inbound flows, three condition codes, and the one decision a supplier is not allowed to make

Two different things come back to a supplier and the portal shows them in one queue because the physical work is identical. A return starts with the customer: after `DELIVERED` they raise a request inside the return window with photo evidence, the shipment moves to `RETURN_REQUESTED`, a reverse pickup job goes out to the fleet that delivered it where possible, and on completion the shipment is `RETURN_PICKED` with the goods physically at the supplier. An RTO starts with a failure: three failed delivery attempts force `RTO_INITIATED` automatically, and the box comes back without the customer having asked for anything. Both land on SP-17.

The supplier action is receipt, not judgement. `POST /partner/returns/:id/receive` records one of three condition codes and closes the shipment to `RETURNED` or `RTO_DELIVERED`, which is what releases the customer refund and reverses the payout accrual. Reverse pickup requires a POD at the supplier end, a photo plus a receiver name, so there is a record of who took the box. The 48-hour dispute window on SP-18 starts at receipt, and the countdown is on the screen because a supplier who discovers the problem on day three has no remedy and should be told that on day one.

| OUTCOME  | WHAT THE SUPPLIER RECORDED                   | WHO BEARS THE COST                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SELLABLE | The goods came back fit to sell again.       | The platform and the fleet. The customer is refunded the goods value, the supplier accrual is clawed back, the forward and reverse delivery fees are already earned by the fleet and are absorbed by us. The supplier restocks with a <code>RETURN_RESTOCK</code> adjustment and is out only the handling.              |
| DAMAGED  | The goods came back unsellable.              | Contested by construction, which is why the dispute button exists. The default is that the customer is refunded and the supplier accrual clawed back; if the supplier evidences that the damage happened after handover, admin can shift the cost to the fleet on arbitration. This is the row most disputes come from. |
| MISSING  | The box arrived without the goods, or short. | Unresolved until arbitration, always. Nobody can tell from a photo whether a customer sent an empty box or a warehouse mis-picked. Recording <code>MISSING</code> creates the dispute rather than settling it.                                                                                                          |

| OUTCOME       | WHAT THE SUPPLIER RECORDED           | WHO BEARS THE COST                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RTO_DELIVERED | An undeliverable shipment came back. | The customer is refunded in full and pays nothing; they did not cause this. The fleet keeps its attempted-delivery fee under the retained-fee rules, which are named explicitly in P8-BE2-03 rather than buried in the arithmetic. |

Every one of those movements is a compensating ledger row, never an edit. A returned shipment reverses its accrual with a new signed row, the fleet fee is clawed back the same way, and P8-BE2-03 forbids netting a clawback against a future accrual: both rows stay visible so a supplier can see the credit and the debit that cancelled it rather than an unexplained smaller number next week.

## A supplier may recommend a rejection. It may not make one

SP-18 has a dispute button and no reject button, and P8-BE1-01 states the constraint in one line: a supplier recommendation never changes the return state by itself. What the supplier gets is a comment and an evidence upload inside 48 hours of receipt, which lands in an ops queue. The decision, approve, reject or partial approve, is an admin action on the AA-05 return screens with a mandatory reason and a before-and-after audit diff. Its acceptance test in P8-FE2-01 is worth quoting as a review criterion: a supplier cannot see any control that would change a return state.

The reason is incentive, not distrust of any particular supplier. The supplier is the only party to the transaction that loses money when a return is approved, and it is also the party holding the physical evidence, unobserved, after the customer has given the box up. Letting the interested party adjudicate its own liability from evidence only it can see is not a policy question, it is a design error. The customer, meanwhile, is not in the room and has no representative in this portal, so somebody neutral has to be, and at pilot scale that somebody is a member of our ops team reading a photo.

The alternative we considered was auto-rejection on a supplier declaration with a customer appeal path, which is what a larger marketplace with a fraud model can afford. We do not have the volume to train anything, and the failure mode is asymmetric: a wrongly rejected return costs us a customer permanently and a wrongly approved one costs a few hundred rupees. At two pilot suppliers the arbitration load is small enough to absorb by hand, and RB-07 covers the money side of the same argument, answering a settlement dispute from partner\_ledger and the pricing snapshot rather than from anyone recollection.

## 6.8 MONEY AND PAYOUTS

An append-only ledger the supplier can read, a weekly run, and no write path anywhere

The finance area of this portal is four screens and not one mutating endpoint. SP-19 lists payout lines by state, SP-20 opens a run, SP-21 is the append-only running balance with no edit affordance anywhere on it, and SP-22 is the artefact for the supplier accounts department. A supplier who disagrees with a number does not correct it here; they call, and RB-07 has finance answer from partner\_ledger and the pricing snapshot and post a compensating entry. That is invariant I-04 expressed as an interface: because the ledger cannot be edited, the screen has nothing to offer that would edit it.

One accrual line exists per shipment. The accrual cron runs at 02:30 for the previous day deliveries and credits goods value less commission, computed in integer paise with floor rounding, idempotent on shipment id so a replayed DELIVERED event cannot double credit. The rate comes from partner\_rate\_cards, which is effective-dated and never edited in place: publishing a new rate inserts a superseding row. The important consequence for the supplier is the next paragraph.

### THE COMMISSION THAT WAS APPLIED IS STORED ON THE ROW, NOT READ FROM THE RATE CARD

P7-BE2-01 stores the applied commission bps on the ledger row at accrual time. A rate change published in October therefore cannot alter what a September shipment earned, and SP-20 shows the bps that was actually applied per line rather than the current one. The alternative, joining to the rate card at read time, looks tidier and is a reconciliation disaster: every historical statement silently changes the day a rate is renegotiated, and a supplier who exported a statement last week can prove we are lying to them. The effective-dated rate card is still the source at accrual; the row is the record afterwards.

| WHAT A LINE SHOWS | COLUMN      | NOTE                                                                                                  |
|-------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Goods value       | gross_paise | The shipment goods value, not the order value. A three-supplier order produces three unrelated lines. |

| WHAT A LINE SHOWS | COLUMN                    | NOTE                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Applied rate      | commission bps on the row | Rendered next to the amount, so the arithmetic is checkable by hand on screen.                                             |
| Commission        | commission_paise          | Floor rounded in paise. There is no floating point anywhere on the path, enforced by aa/no-float-money.                    |
| TDS               | tds_paise                 | Withheld at source where applicable. Shown as its own line, never folded into commission.                                  |
| Adjustments       | adjustment_paise          | Clawbacks, short-ship corrections and manual finance entries. Itemised, never netted into net_paise silently.              |
| Net               | net_paise                 | What lands in the bank. The sum of the four rows above, and the only figure that appears on the run total.                 |
| State             | status                    | ACCRUED   IN_RUN   PAID   WITHHELD. A withheld line shows its reason on SP-19 rather than simply vanishing from the total. |

The run schedule is weekly and visible. payout-draft runs at 04:00 every Monday and assembles the DRAFT run for the previous week; the run then walks DRAFT to LOCKED to RELEASED to SETTLED, with FAILED as the escape hatch, and membership freezes at LOCKED so a line cannot join or leave a run after finance has started working it. Marking a run paid is an admin action behind step-up. The supplier sees the run appear on SP-19 as IN\_REVIEW membership, then the release, then the last four characters of the UTR on SP-20 once the transfer is made, which is enough to match against a bank statement and is the most we will ever show of a payment reference.

Reversals are displayed as pairs rather than as a smaller number. Where a clawback reverses an earlier accrual, SP-21 renders the two rows adjacent with the later one labelled REVERSAL and carrying a reference to the row it offsets, and the running balance shows the effect of each. This costs vertical space and prevents the single worst support call in settlement, which is a supplier asking why last month total changed. It did not change; a new row was added.

#### CUT C-3: THE INVOICE IS A CSV, NOT A PDF

SP-22 was specified as one self-billed commission invoice PDF per released run. That was cut for two dev-days. What ships behind p.invoice.download is a CSV of the run: one row per payout line with gross, applied bps, commission, TDS, adjustment and net, plus a total row that reconciles to the paise against the ledger for the period. The screen and the permission stay exactly as specified so the contract does not move when the PDF arrives. Accounting generates the actual invoice document by hand for the pilot suppliers, which is roughly fifteen minutes a week for three organisations and does not scale past ten. Every supplier will ask for the PDF, and the answer during the pilot is that we email it.

#### BANK VERIFICATION IS A PERSON, NOT AN API

A supplier saves an account on SP-23; it enters PENDING\_VERIFICATION and payouts pause. Accruals continue, but P3-BE1-06 blocks an unverified organisation from being included in a run at all. Verification is a staff member transferring Rs 1 by UPI and matching the returned holder name against partner\_bank\_accounts.holder\_name, then setting verified\_at from AD-22 behind step-up. The paid alternative is a Cashfree or Razorpay penny-drop at roughly Rs 3 per verification, which is billed per call and therefore excluded by invariant I-14. At two suppliers and one fleet this is about ten minutes of work a week. The honest failure case is a supplier who changes their account on a Friday afternoon and misses the Monday run.

## 6.9 WHAT A SUPPLIER CAN NEVER SEE OR DO

The boundary, and the mechanism that holds each line of it rather than the intention behind it

This is the table to read if you only read one page of this document. Each row states a limit, what the supplier actually receives instead, and the thing in the code or the database that makes it so. The last column is the point: a boundary that exists only as a policy or as an absent button is not a boundary, and every line below is held by a guard that runs before the handler, a database rule, a missing route, or a permission that does not exist in the type union at all.

| CANNOT                      | WHAT THEY GET INSTEAD                      | MECHANISM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| See a customer phone number | Nothing. The field is not in the response. | AA-08 marks users.phone as never for a partner principal. It is stored as cipher plus last four plus an HMAC index, and the Prisma client extension masks unconditionally at the ORM boundary. There is deliberately no pii.read.raw permission in the Permission union, so there is no grant an engineer could add. aa/no-raw-pii-render fails the build on a JSX expression rendering a phone-shaped field. |

| CANNOT                                             | WHAT THEY GET INSTEAD                                   | MECHANISM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| See a customer name                                | Nothing on any of the 26 screens.                       | AA-08 permits a partner principal a first name; this specification declines to use it and no partner response carries it. The SP-08 label prints the shipment code, the pick lines and the drop pincode, and P4-FE2-01 asks for a code review confirming no customer contact field is fetched by the fulfilment screens at all.                                |
| See a delivery address or coordinates              | Drop locality and pincode on SP-06.                     | addresses.line1 and line2 are ciphertext; coordinates are ciphertext rounded to three decimals on read and are never released to a partner. The full address exists exactly once, on GET /fleet/jobs/:id/manifest, which is job-scoped, expires after MANIFEST_WINDOW_MINUTES of 240 and writes a pii_disclosures row in the same transaction. Invariant I-07. |
| See another supplier catalog, price or performance | 404 on a guessed id; nothing in any list.               | scoped(prisma, principal) injects the org predicate into the where clause and is the only permitted entry point in the partner namespace, so the query returns zero rows rather than rows the handler then filters. P9-BE1-02 asserts 404 and never 403.                                                                                                       |
| Write to the ledger                                | A read-only balance and a phone call.                   | Every finance route under /partner is a GET except PUT /partner/bank. A Postgres rule raises on UPDATE and DELETE against partner_ledger, partner_payouts and wallet_ledger, so even a mistaken server-side write fails at the database. Invariant I-04.                                                                                                       |
| Write an order status                              | A shipment transition, which the order is derived from. | orders.status is produced by reduceOrderStatus() and maintained only by orders/fsm.ts. aa/no-status-write fails any status key inside a prisma update outside fsm.ts. Invariant I-11.                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Export anything containing PII                     | No export route at all.                                 | There is no /partner/exports endpoint to call. Export is an admin capability behind export.create, capped at EXPORT_ROW_CAP of 5000 rows and masked by the same extension, and cut C-2 removed CSV export from this release regardless.                                                                                                                        |
| Reach the admin or fleet namespace                 | 401 ACTOR_MISMATCH.                                     | The token is minted with the atv_partner audience. requireActor() runs immediately after JWT verification and before any handler or permission check, and the twelve wrong-audience combinations are an integration test from P1-BE1-02. Invariant I-02.                                                                                                       |
| Force a shipment or return state                   | Only the transitions listed for the partner actor.      | assertTransition enforces the sixteen-state shipment FSM with its permitted actors per edge; a partner token cannot drive an edge marked fleet or staff. Forcing one is an admin drawer on AD-08 requiring a twenty-character reason and an audit diff.                                                                                                        |

## 6.10 STATES, MOBILE REALITY AND ACCESSIBILITY

Four states per screen, one concession the admin portal does not make, and what it costs

Every screen in section 6.4 ships four states before it ships a happy path, and a pull request that omits one is not finished. The rules are the same as AA-05 section 5.10 with one substitution: where the admin portal names the permission a staff user is missing, this portal does not, and where the admin portal returns 403 for a resource belonging to someone else, this portal returns 404. Section 6.2 explains why.

| STATE   | WHAT IT SHOWS                                                                                                         | RULE                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Empty   | A sentence saying what would appear here, and the action that creates the first one.                                  | No illustration, no exclamation mark. An empty shipment queue is good news and should read as such; an empty product list on an ACTIVE organisation is a problem and should read as that instead.                           |
| Loading | A skeleton of the layout that is coming, not a spinner in the middle of a blank frame.                                | The skeleton must occupy the final height. A queue that reflows when it loads causes a clerk to tap the wrong shipment, which on SP-07 is a wrongly packed box.                                                             |
| Error   | What failed, whether it is safe to retry, and a retry control.                                                        | The error code is shown in small text so a support call can quote it. A 409 on the stock grid or the gate screen is not an error state but a decision state and gets the current server value plus a choice, per P3-FE2-02. |
| Denied  | On their own resource, a 403 panel naming the action in plain words. On anything else, the ordinary not-found screen. | The permission code is never shown; a supplier has no catalog to look it up in and the code would be meaningless. The copy names who in their organisation can do it instead, which is almost always the owner.             |

The concession this portal makes and the admin portal refuses is that the fulfilment path must work on a mid-range Android phone browser at a 360 px viewport. This is not a nice-to-have: a warehouse clerk does not walk to a desk to accept a shipment, and P4-FE2-02 states the acceptance test as the gate screen working one-handed at 360 px. The admin portal assumes a laptop and a keyboard and is designed around dense tables because a staff user comparing forty rows is doing real work. A clerk comparing forty rows is lost.

What that costs is a second layout for six screens. Below 768 px the shipment queue on SP-05 is a card list, one shipment per card, with the ready-by time and the item count as the only two fields and a single primary action; the table layout appears above that width. SP-07 becomes a full-width checklist with tap targets sized for a thumb rather than a row of cells. SP-09 is phone-first and its desktop form is the compromise, not the reverse.

That is more work than one responsive stylesheet and it is the honest price of the constraint.

**WHAT STAYS DESKTOP-ONLY, ON PURPOSE**

SP-21 the ledger and the SP-20 payout statement are not made to work at 360 px. They are wide by nature and the person reading them is a bookkeeper at a desk with a spreadsheet open beside them, not a clerk on a shift. Below 768 px both screens show a plain message saying the statement needs a wider screen, with the period total and the net figure rendered so the trip was not wasted. Pretending to squeeze six money columns into a phone produces a table nobody can reconcile from, which is worse than declining.

**ACCESSIBILITY, AND THE GAP IN THE PLAN**

P9-FE2-01 puts the supplier portal through the same axe and keyboard pass as the admin portal: every action reachable by keyboard, visible focus, labelled inputs, and no colour-only state, which matters here because moderation and shipment states are both chip-rendered and both carry a word as well as a colour. The gap worth naming is that the 3G-throttled mid-range Android test in that task is written against the fleet portal only. SP-09 and SP-05 need the same treatment and this document asks for them to be added to it; a gate screen that takes eight seconds to become interactive is a gate screen nobody uses.

6.11 WHAT THIS PORTAL WILL NOT DO IN THESE TEN WEEKS

Seven omissions, the workaround for each, and the point at which the workaround stops working

None of the following is a bug and none of it is on the ten-week plan. Each one has a workaround that is genuinely adequate at pilot scale and genuinely inadequate somewhere beyond it, so the useful thing to write down is the second half: where the workaround breaks. A supplier will ask for most of these during onboarding, and the person answering should be able to say what we do instead and when we expect to stop doing it that way.

| NOT IN THIS RELEASE                                                                               | WHAT A SUPPLIER DOES INSTEAD                                                                                                                                                        | WHERE THAT BREAKS                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A public partner API. A supplier ERP cannot integrate with us at all; see AA-04 section 4.10.     | Everything goes through the portal by hand, plus the CSV paste box on SP-14 for stock, which is the only machine-shaped input in the product.                                       | At the first supplier whose stock genuinely lives in Tally or an ERP and who will not double-enter it. Also immediately if a supplier asks for shipments to be pushed to them rather than polled by a person. |
| Bulk catalog import. Creating a listing means walking the SP-11 wizard once per product.          | We load the opening catalog on the supplier behalf from a spreadsheet through an admin-side seed, then they maintain it in the portal.                                              | Around 150 SKUs, or at the fourth supplier, whichever comes first. The seed is our labour and it does not scale with the cohort.                                                                              |
| The self-billed commission invoice PDF, cut C-3.                                                  | A CSV of the released run from SP-22, and accounting produces the invoice document manually for the pilot suppliers.                                                                | Past roughly ten suppliers the manual step is a weekly job rather than fifteen minutes, and at the first GST audit the provenance of a hand-made invoice is a conversation.                                   |
| Saved views and list CSV export, cut C-2.                                                         | Fixed default filters only: SP-05 opens on AWAITING_ACCEPTANCE, SP-19 on accrued lines. No column chooser, no saved filter, no download of a list.                                  | The cut note says within a month, and that is about right for the supplier side too. The first supplier with two warehouses will want a filter we did not anticipate.                                         |
| In-portal messaging with our staff. There is no thread, no inbox and no unread count anywhere.    | A dispute, a moderation argument or a settlement query is an email or a call to the support line, and SP-18 evidence uploads carry the supplier written comment into the ops queue. | The moment support volume outgrows one person holding it in their head. It also means the audit trail of a commercial dispute lives in a mailbox rather than against the record it concerns.                  |
| Notification preferences. The templates in P5-BE1-03 are fixed and cannot be redirected or muted. | The organisation uses a shared mailbox for the owner account, or forwards from it.                                                                                                  | When the warehouse wants shipment alerts and the owner does not want payout figures going to the same address. That is a real conflict and it arrives with the second seat.                                   |
| Demand or category insight. The scorecard reports the supplier own conduct, not the market.       | Eleven fixed dashboard tiles and a conversation with our category team about what to stock.                                                                                         | As soon as a supplier is deciding what to list rather than how to ship it. A hosted reporting layer is a named paid gap at roughly \$85 a month and is excluded by invariant I-14.                            |

Requests against this list are not lost. P10-FE2-01 reserves two days per portal in the pilot week for fixes and triages everything arriving from a pilot organisation into blocking, friction and wish, fixing only the first two inside the window and writing every wish item into the post-pilot backlog with the requesting organisation named. Naming the organisation is the part that matters: it turns a feature list into evidence about which supplier will leave if we do not build it.